reproduction includes fission (In unicellular forms the cell divides mitotically to produce two daughter cells Example: *Chlamydomonas)*; Fragmentation (fragments of parent thallus grow into new individual Example: *Ulothrix*) budding (A lateral bud is formed in some members like *Protosiphon* and helps in reproduction) bulbils, (a wedge shaped modified branch develop in *Sphacelaria*) akinetes (Thick walled spores meant for perennation and germinates with the advent of favourable condition Example: *Pithophora*) and Tubers (Structures found on the rhizoids and the lower nodes of *Chara* which store food materials).

Asexual reproduction takes place by the production of zoospores motile spores (*Ulothrix, Oedogonium*) aplanospore (thin walled non motile spores Example: *Vaucheria*); autospores (spores which look similar to parent cell Example: *Chlorella*); hypnospore (thick walled aplanospore – Example: *Chlamydomonas nivalis*) and Tetraspores (Diploid thallus of *Polysiphonia* produce haploid spores after meiosis).

Sexual reproduction in algae is of three types 1. Isogamy (Fusion of morphologically and Physiologically similar gametes Example: *Ulothrix*) 2. Anisogamy (Fusion of either morphologically or physiologically dissimilar gametes Example: *Pandorina*) 3. Oogamy (Fusion of both morphologically and physiologically dissimilar gametes. Example: *Sargassum*). The life cycle shows distinct alternation of generation.



The Oldest recorded alga is Grypania, which was discovered in the banded iron formations of northern Michigan and dated to approximately 2100Ma

2.3.2. Classification

F.E. Fritsch proposed a classification for algae based on pigmentation, types of flagella, reserve food materials, thallus structure and reproduction. He published his classification in the book "The structure and reproduction of the Algae"(1935). He classified algae into 11 classesnamelyChlorophyceae,Xanthophyceae, Chrysophyceae, Bacillariophyceae, Cryptophyceae, Dinophyceae, Chloromonadineae, Euglenophyceae, Phaeophyceae, Rhodophyceae, Cyanophyceae (Table 2.2).

The salient features of Chlorophyceae, Phaeophyceae and Rhodophyceae are given below.

Chlorophyceae

The members are commonly called **'Green algae'**. Most of the species are aquatic(Fresh water-*Spirogyra*, Marine -*Ulva*). A few are terrestrial(*Trentipohlia*). Variation among the shape of the chloroplast is found in members of algae. It is cup shaped (*Chlamydomonas*), discoid (*Chara*), girdle shaped, (*Ulothrix*), reticulate (*Oedogonium*), spiral (*Spirogyra*), stellate (*Zygnema*) and plate like (*Mougeoutia*).

Chlorophyll 'a' and Chlorophyll 'b' are the major photosynthetic pigments. Storage bodies called pyrenoids are present in the chloroplast and store starch. They also contain proteins. The cell wall is made up of inner layer of cellulose and outer layer of pectin. Vegetative reproduction takes place by means of fragmentation and asexual reproduction is by the production of zoospores, aplanospores and akinetes. Sexual reproduction is present and may be isogamous, anisogamous or oogamous. Examples for this group of algae includes *Chlorella, Chlamydomonas, Volvox, Spirogyra, Ulothrix, Chara* and *Ulva.*

Phaeophyceae

The members of this class are called **'Brown algae'**. Majority of the forms are found in marine habitats. *Pleurocladia* is a fresh water form. The thallus is filamentous (*Ectocarpus*) frond like (*Dictyota*)or may be giant kelps (*Laminaria*

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